

Lispy | 

(Task 1 of 9) In this tutorial, we will learn about **lambda expressions**, which are expressions that create functions.

The following program illustrates how to create a function without giving it a name and then call it immediately.

```
Lispy [Run ▶] Scala 3
((lambda (n) ((n : Int) => n + 1)(2))
 (+ n 1))
2)
```

The function is created by a lambda expression. This function increases its parameter by one.

```
Lispy [Run ▶] Scala 3
(lambda (n) (n : Int) => n + 1
 (+ n 1))
```

Any feedback regarding these statements? Feel free to skip this question.

1

(You skipped the question.)

2

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(Task 2 of 9) What is the result of running this program?

```
Lispy [Run ▶] JavaScript
(deffun (f x)          function f(x) {
  (lambda (y) (+ x y))) return function (y) {
(defvar x 0)           return x + y;
((f 2) 1)              };
                       }
                       let x = 0;
                       console.log(f(2)(1));
```

3

4

You predicted the output correctly 🎉🎉🎉

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This program is essentially the same as

```
Lispy [Run ▶] Python
(deffun (f x)          def f(x):
  (deffun (fun y)      def fun(y):
    (+ x y))          return x + y
  fun)               return fun
(defvar x 0)          x = 0
((f 2) 1)             print(f(2)(1))
```

Click [here](#) to run this program in the Stacker.

(Task 3 of 9) What is the result of running this program?

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Lispy [Run ▶]	JavaScript
<code>(deffun (bar y)</code>	<code>function bar(y) {</code>
<code>(lambda (x)</code>	<code>return function (x) {</code>
<code>(+ x y)))</code>	<code>return x + y;</code>
<code>(defvar f (bar 2))</code>	<code>};</code>
<code>(defvar g (bar 4))</code>	<code>}</code>
<code>(f 2)</code>	<code>let f = bar(2);</code>
<code>(g 2)</code>	<code>let g = bar(4);</code>
	<code>console.log(f(2));</code>
	<code>console.log(g(2));</code>

4 6

7

You predicted the output correctly 🎉🎉🎉

8

The value of `(bar 2)` is a lambda function defined in an environment where `y` is bound to 2. The value of `(bar 4)` is *another* lambda function defined in an environment where `y` is bound to 4. The two lambda functions are *different* values. So, the value of `(f 2)` is 12, while the value of `(g 2)` is 52.

Click [here](#) to run this program in the Stacker.

(Task 4 of 9) What is the result of running this program?

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Lispy [Run ▶]	Python
<code>(defvar x 1)</code>	<code>x = 1</code>
<code>(deffun (f)</code>	<code>def f():</code>
<code>(lambda (y)</code>	<code>return lambda y: x + y</code>
<code>(+ x y)))</code>	<code>g = f()</code>
<code>(defvar g (f))</code>	<code>x = 2</code>
<code>(set! x 2)</code>	<code>print(g(0))</code>
<code>(g 0)</code>	

2

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You predicted the output correctly 🎉🎉🎉

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`x` is bound to 1. `g` is bound to the lambda function. `(set! x 2)` binds `x` to 2. So, the value of `(g 0)` is the value of `(+ 2 0)`, which is 2.

Click [here](#) to run this program in the Stacker.

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(Task 5 of 9) What is the result of running this program?

Lispy [Run 

JavaScript

```
(deffun (foobar)
  (defvar n 0)
  (lambda ()
    (set! n (+ n 1))
    n))
(defvar f (foobar))
(defvar g (foobar))

(f)
(g)
(f)
```

```
function foobar() {
  let n = 0;
  return function () {
    n = n + 1;
    return n;
  };
}
let f = foobar();
let g = foobar();
console.log(f());
console.log(g());
console.log(f());
```

1 1 2

13

You predicted the output correctly 🎉🎉🎉

14

Every time `foobar` is called, it creates a *new* environment that binds `n`. So, `f` and `g` have different bindings for the `n` variable. When `f` is called the first time, it mutates its binding for the `n` variable. `g` has its own binding for the `n` variable, which still binds `n` to `0`. So, `(g)` produces `1` rather than `2`. The second call to `f` produces `2` rather than `1`.

Click [here](#) to run this program in the Stacker.

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(Task 6 of 9)

Lispy [Run 

JavaScript

```
(deffun (f x y z) body)
function f(x, y, z) {
  return body;
}
```

is a "shorthand" for

Lispy [Run 

JavaScript

```
(defvar f (lambda (x y z) body))
let f = function (x, y, z) {
  return body;
}
```

Any feedback regarding these statements? Feel free to skip this question.

16

(You skipped the question.)

17

(Task 7 of 9) Please rewrite this function definition as a variable definition that binds lambda function.

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Lispy [Run]

Scala 3

```
(deffun (f x) (+ x 1))  def f(x : Int) =
                        x + 1
```

```
(defvar f (lambda (x) (+ x 1)))
```

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The correct answer is

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Lispy [Run]

JavaScript

```
(defvar f (lambda (x) (+ x 1)))  let f = function (x) {
                                return x + 1;
                                }
```

A common wrong answer is

Lispy [Run]

JavaScript

```
(defvar f (lambda (f x) (+ x 1)))  let f = function (f, x) {
                                return x + 1;
                                }
```

which makes `f` a function that takes two parameters rather than one

(Task 8 of 9) Here is a program that confused many students

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Lispy [Run]

Scala 3

```
(deffun (foo n)          def foo(n : Int) =
  (deffun (bar)          def bar =
    (set! n (+ n 1))      n = n + 1
    n)                  n
  bar)                  bar
(defvar f (foo 0))       var f = foo(0)
(defvar g (foo 0))       var g = foo(0)
                        println(f)
(f)                     println(g)
(g)                     println(f)
(f)
```

Please

1. Run this program in the stacker by clicking one of the [Run] buttons above;
2. The stacker would show how this program produces its result(s);
3. Keep clicking ▶▶ Next until you reach a configuration that you find particularly helpful;

4. Click  Share This Configuration to get a link to your configuration;

5. Submit your link below;

https://smol-tutor.xyz/stacker/?syntax=Lispy&randomSeed=smol-
tutor&hole=%E2%80%A2&nNext=21&program=%0A%28deffun+%28foo+n%29%0A++
%28deffun+%28bar%29%0A++++%28set%21+n+%28%2B+n+1%29%29%0A+++
+n%29%0A++bar%29%0A%28defvar+f+%28foo+0%29%29%0A%28defvar+g+
%28foo+0%29%29%0A%0A%28f%29%0A%28g%29%0A%28f%29%0A&readOnlyMode=

22

(Task 9 of 9) Please write a couple of sentences to explain how your configuration explains the result(s) of the program.

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"

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Let's review what we have learned in this tutorial.

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In this tutorial, we will learn about **lambda expressions**, which are expressions that create functions.

The following program illustrates how to create a function without giving it a name and then call it immediately.

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((lambda (n) ((n : Int) => n + 1)(2))
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```

The function is created by a lambda expression. This function increases its parameter by one.

```
Lispy [Run] Scala 3
(lambda (n) (n : Int) => n + 1
 (+ n 1))
```

```
Lispy [Run] Scala 3
(deffun (f x y z) body) def f(x : Int, y : Int, z : Int) =
                        body
```

is a "shorthand" for

```
Lispy [Run]
(defvar f (lambda (x y z) body)) var f = (x : Int, y : Int, z : Int)
                                body
```

You have finished this tutorial 🎉🎉🎉

Please the finished tutorial to a PDF file so you can review the content in the future. **Your instructor (if any) might require you to submit the PDF.**

Start time: 1781420265751